THE NEW CAROUSEL BASELINE

A reference-led production contract for AI tools, designers and editors.



FULL BLEED.
TALL TYPE.
CONTROLLED GOLD.
REAL PRESENCE.

Upload this PDF with your original photographs and slide copy. The embedded references define the look; the specifications define how to reproduce it.

This document supersedes the previous cream-border / rounded-card carousel treatment. The PDF page design is documentation, not a carousel template.

01 / HOW TO USE THIS

Read this page before generating anything.

THE THREE REQUIRED INPUTS

1. This entire PDF. 2. Original high-resolution photographs. 3. Carousel text in the desired order. Include a brand name and CTA when they differ from the supplied text.

THE DEFAULT OUTPUT

Individual 1080 x 1080 square slides, numbered in reading order, plus a contact-sheet preview and a ZIP. Use all relevant supplied photographs with purposeful rotation. Never deliver only a montage.

WHAT IS LOCKED

Full-bleed photographic base; condensed uppercase display typography; off-white and aged-gold hierarchy; dark atmospheric surroundings; visible natural skin and physique; asymmetrical composition; controlled sequence pacing.

WHAT MAY ADAPT

Photo crop, left/right text placement, number of lines and slide count when permitted. Copy must fit the subject and negative space. The old reference topic and offer wording are not default copy.

REALISTIC EXPECTATION

A PDF is a design contract, not executable software. Reproduction requires a tool that can read images/PDFs, compose photos and render text. Exact fonts require font assets. The system must inspect and correct its output; no one-pass or pixel-identical guarantee.

02 / THE APPROVED REFERENCES

The five new screenshots are the authority. Do not imitate the Instagram interface.



A / Right-side manifesto



B / Upper-left challenge



C / Split declaration



D / Typographic climax



E / Offer close

Exclude status bars, usernames, carousel badges, reaction avatars, music icons, likes, captions and Boost Post controls. The artwork is square and edge-to-edge. Reference footers contain inconsistent numbering: fix numbering in new work.

03 / VISUAL DNA + PALETTE

The following hex values are production targets inferred from the references, not original source-file measurements.

Ink	Storm teal	Off-white	Aged gold	Deep gold	CTA violet
#080D10	#253A40	#E8E5DC	#C3A052	#94713B	#70469A

COLOR HAS A JOB

Photography supplies most color. Off-white carries setup and explanation; aged gold carries the reversal, key claim or decisive word. Violet belongs only to an existing product/offer accent on the closing slide, not every slide.

ATMOSPHERE, NOT DECORATION

Cool stormy shadows, restrained saturation, warm natural skin and subtle film texture. Gold should read as aged ink or metal, not bright yellow neon. No chrome, generic trading dashboards, floating icons or random luxury props.

FULL BLEED IS NON-NEGOTIABLE

Image runs to all four edges. No cream mat, white frame, rounded corners, card shadow or persistent header bar. Small editorial footers and occasional fine gold rules are allowed.

04 / TYPOGRAPHY SYSTEM

Tall, narrow, heavy, uppercase. Not the wide outlined sans-serif used in the rejected revisions.

FONT IDENTIFICATION

The exact original font cannot be authenticated from screenshots. Use an Anton-style condensed grotesque as the first practical match; Bebas Neue Bold or a comparable licensed heavy condensed face is a fallback. Choose by matching the references, not by font name alone. Do not use regular-weight Bebas as a substitute for heavy type.

1080 PX TYPE SCALE

Climax: 132-188 px. Main headline: 84-126 px. Setup / secondary display: 48-72 px. Supporting body: 28-36 px. Eyebrow and footer: 18-24 px. These are starting ranges: rendered cap-height and readable fit are the acceptance tests.

SPACING + EMPHASIS

Display baseline-to-baseline spacing: start near 0.95-1.08 x font size; inspect visible glyph clearance. Keep at least 8 px between adjacent headline glyph bounds. Headline tracking: -1 to +1 px; eyebrows/footer: +2 to +4 px. Separate conceptual blocks by 28-48 px.

TYPE FINISH

Use restrained grain within the letters only when it remains legible. Avoid hard black outlines, bevels, glow around every letter and multiple font families. Supporting prose may use a clean sans-serif. Never mechanically stretch text to force a fit.

LINE BREAKS

Break at meaningful phrases. Preserve punctuation and emphasis. Never leave a single accidental orphan word. Measure final glyph bounds after font loading; do not position the next block using guessed font heights.

05 / PHOTO + GRADING RULES

The photograph remains a real portrait, not raw material for an invented person.

IDENTITY LOCK

Use supplied photos only. Preserve face, body, skin tone, clothing, tattoos, proportions and distinguishing details. No muscle enhancement, skin smoothing, fabricated wardrobe, replacement people or invented locations.

SUBJECT FIRST

Choose the photo with usable negative space before selecting a layout. Keep text away from eyes, face, hands and key physique areas. Never crop through a hand or joint unnecessarily. Do not mirror photos: clothing text, tattoos and scene direction must stay authentic.

GRADE LOCALLY

Lower distracting background saturation and bright spots gently. Introduce cool shadow atmosphere without turning skin blue or orange. Preserve highlights and muscle separation. Use a feathered background gradient behind text; do not darken the entire photograph to solve readability.

EFFECT RESTRAINT

Fine grain and soft atmospheric glow should be felt, not seen as effects. No fake lightning, smoke clouds, excessive particles, HDR halos or heavy vignettes swallowing the body. Optional CTA gold light remains subtle and localized.

LAYER ORDER

Photo, local color/exposure adjustments, background-only contrast mask, typography, optional fine rule/footer, final subtle grain. Foreground subject masking over giant type is allowed only on the climax and only if every word remains readable.

06 / LAYOUT GRAMMAR

Coordinates below use a 1080 x 1080 canvas with the origin at the top-left. Adapt within the stated zones.

GLOBAL SAFE AREA

Keep essential glyphs within x=60-1020 and y=60-1010. Reserve 40-60 px between the text column and protected subject silhouette. Footer: y=972-1008. Artwork still extends fully to the edges.

A / RIGHT-SIDE MANIFESTO

Subject occupies roughly x=55-570. Text column x=630-1000, y=150-900. Use a small setup, a large stacked gold list, then a compact off-white challenge. One edge alignment across all blocks. Use a shorter list if the copy is not naturally list-like.

B / UPPER-LEFT CHALLENGE

Text x=70-590, y=65-505. Subject sits lower-right, roughly x=480-1010, y=400-1080. Large off-white statement, short gold bridge, then off-white question. Place a short rule/footer directly below the text group.

C / SPLIT DECLARATION

Text x=60-560, y=270-760. Subject occupies the right half. A short off-white premise gives way to a larger gold reversal. Keep this slide sparse: one argument, not a paragraph plus a feature list.

NON-COLLISION RULE

Zones are starting bounds, not permission to cover a person. If text cannot fit at a readable size, change the crop or template. If it still cannot fit, split the slide when allowed. Never overlap text blocks or shrink body copy into microtype.

07 / CLIMAX + OFFER CLOSE

These are controlled exceptions that make the sequence feel cinematic rather than repetitive.





D / THE TYPOGRAPHIC CLIMAX

Full-width headline x=60-1020, y=45-460. Off-white setup above one dominant gold line. Subject lower-center, with optional silhouette overlap limited to the lower edge of the headline. Supporting lines sit in unused space, never across the face.

E / THE OFFER CLOSE

Subject on the left; offer title and concise promise upper-right; supplied product mockups lower-right. Restrained black/gold scene with existing violet product accents. Use one primary CTA and at most one alternative route if explicitly supplied.

NO INVENTED SALES ASSETS

Use actual supplied logo and mockups. If absent, create a photo-led typographic close, not fictional course boxes or a made-up crest. Never inherit old prices, benefits, results, DM keywords or urgency from the reference.

08 / PACING + COPY DENSITY

The sequence varies scale and placement while keeping the same visual language.

FIVE-SLIDE RHYTHM

1. Hook or manifesto (A/B). 2. Challenge with context (B). 3. Sparse reversal (C). 4. Largest typographic declaration (D). 5. Offer or next step (E). Choose sequence to match the supplied narrative, not the screenshot filenames or old footer numbers.

LONGER CAROUSELS

For 8-12 slides, add context and evidence between the hook and reversal. After every two information-heavy slides, insert a shorter statement slide if the copy supports it. Reserve the largest scale for the climax. Do not repeat one layout more than twice consecutively.

PHOTO ROTATION

Rotate relevant images and camera scales; do not force every photo into the set. Avoid adjacent identical crops. Repeating a hero photo can unify the story when a materially different crop is available. Do not fabricate new angles.

COPY BUDGET

Target 12-35 words on statement slides, 35-65 on context slides, and 20-50 on the close. These are design limits, not permission to delete user copy. For longer exact copy, split logically when allowed; if slide count is locked, flag the conflict before silently editing.

SOFT BUT LOUD

Let the argument create interest before the offer arrives. Avoid pricing strips, feature-card grids and repeated CTAs. Preserve any required financial or health disclaimer at a readable size. Claims must come from the user, not the design reference.

09 / PRODUCTION + QUALITY GATES

No final delivery until every gate passes.

BUILD IN THIS ORDER

Read the brief and references. Inventory photos. Map copy to slide roles. Select photo and layout per slide. Lock fonts and palette. Grade images. Typeset using measurable text layers. Render each slide. Inspect and correct. Export the final set.

TEXT MUST BE RELIABLE

Prefer exact editable/typeset text over generated lettering. If an image model creates the lettering, verify every word and repair errors before delivery. Never claim exact copy when words, punctuation or lines have changed.

GEOMETRY CHECK

All slides 1080 x 1080. No text-block intersections, edge clipping, hidden letters or logo collisions. Check glyph bounds rather than just text boxes. Read slide numbers in sequence. No screenshot UI or reaction avatars.

VISUAL CHECK

Review each slide at 100% and at approximately 360 x 360 phone size. Headlines must read immediately; support text must remain legible. Compare all slides on a contact sheet for color consistency, subject exposure, pacing and placement.

DELIVERY

Export sRGB PNGs or high-quality JPEGs named 01-cover, 02-context and so on. Deliver numbered individual slides, one separate contact sheet and one ZIP. Keep the preview out of the numbered slide sequence. Do not state that visual checks passed unless they actually did.

10 / REUSABLE AI PROMPT

Attach this PDF, original photographs and your copy. This prompt is also readable directly from the PDF.

COPY AND PASTE

Create the complete carousel using the attached Operator Carousel Baseline PDF as the visual authority. Read every page and inspect the five embedded references. Use the supplied original photos and carousel copy. Produce final slide images, not only a plan.

LOCK THE LOOK

Use 1080 x 1080 full-bleed photography; tall heavy condensed display type; off-white and aged-gold emphasis; cool cinematic surroundings with natural, visible skin; asymmetrical layouts; purposeful negative space. No cream borders, rounded frames, wide outlined headlines or generic coaching-flyer graphics.

PROTECT THE INPUTS

Preserve my identity and the supplied copy. Do not invent claims, testimonials, prices, credentials, offers or assets. Reference copy and screenshot UI are not content to reproduce. Use supplied logos/mockups only. If an exact font is unavailable, use the closest heavy condensed match and disclose the substitution.

COMPOSE THE SEQUENCE

Choose among layouts A-E according to each photo and message. Rotate relevant photos and crops. Keep key text clear of the face and physique. Escalate to one typographic climax, then close with the supplied CTA. If text will not fit, split it only when slide-count flexibility is permitted; otherwise flag the constraint.

FINISH THE WORK

Typeset accurately, verify copy, measure collisions, inspect every slide at full size and phone size, and correct problems. Export numbered 1080 x 1080 images, a contact sheet and a ZIP. Do not claim completion if the tool cannot render or verify the files.

11 / INPUT CARD + FINAL TEST

A lightweight brief anyone on the team can attach to the same PDF.

PASTE UNDER YOUR UPLOADS

Brand / page: [name]
Topic and intended takeaway: [one sentence]
Slide count: [number; fixed or flexible]
Copy: [numbered, exact wording]
CTA: [exact action / destination]
Photos: [attached originals]
Logo / mockups: [attached, or none]
Copy edits allowed: [default: no]
Special constraints: [optional]

WHEN INFORMATION IS MISSING

If the brand and CTA appear in the copy, use them. If slide count is absent, choose the minimum count that keeps the copy readable. If no CTA is supplied, finish with the final supplied takeaway. Do not invent a sales action. Ask only when a missing asset or conflicting requirement blocks faithful production.

THE FIVE-SECOND TEST

Does it look like the approved five-image campaign? Is the subject visible? Is the dominant message obvious? Is there room to breathe? Would the image still work without decorative effects? If any answer is no, revise before export.

AUTHORITY + LIMITS

New explicit user instructions override defaults. Otherwise these five references and this PDF supersede older carousel treatments. Numerical settings are reproducible design targets, not recovered source-file metadata. Embedded screenshot overlays are evidence only and must never appear in final artwork.